

Question 21 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the structure of an HRD system and describe its major components.

Introduction

A system is a set of parts that work together toward a purpose. An HRD system is not a training calendar hanging on a wall. It is an organised arrangement of philosophy, mechanisms, people and information that continuously develops individuals, boss–subordinate pairs, teams and the whole organisation. Structure means how those parts are arranged and linked.

Detailed points

- 1. Foundation — HRD philosophy and goals.** At the base are beliefs that people have potential and that development is planned. Goals include individual capability, role capability, future roles, dyads, teams, collaboration and organisational health (as listed in Unit 1). If this foundation is missing, components become disconnected activities.
- 2. Performance appraisal.** A periodic, developmental review of results and behaviours. It identifies strengths and gaps and feeds other components. In an HRD system, appraisal is not only for increment.
- 3. Potential appraisal.** Judgement of capacity for higher or different roles. Prevents promoting people only because they are good in the present job.
- 4. Training and development.** Planned learning to close gaps and prepare future work. Includes education and longer development, not only skill drills.
- 5. Career planning.** A blueprint of possible paths from entry toward later roles, integrating individual aspirations with organisational needs. It is a process, not a one-time form.
- 6. Feedback, counselling and OD/climate.** Feedback and counselling turn data into change through conversation. OD, team building and climate work develop the organisation's health — the system's outer layer.
- 7. Supporting structure.** HRD staff, line managers as developers, information records, and links to HRM (pay, placement, promotions). Without these supports, components cannot operate.
- 8. Interrelation is part of structure.** The structure is a network: appraisal data → counselling and TNA → training → career moves → new appraisal. Periodic check whether mechanisms help or hinder the HRD process is also structural (a review loop).

Conclusion. Define HRD as a system, list components with one function each, and stress that structure = linkage + philosophy + line ownership, not a pile of forms.